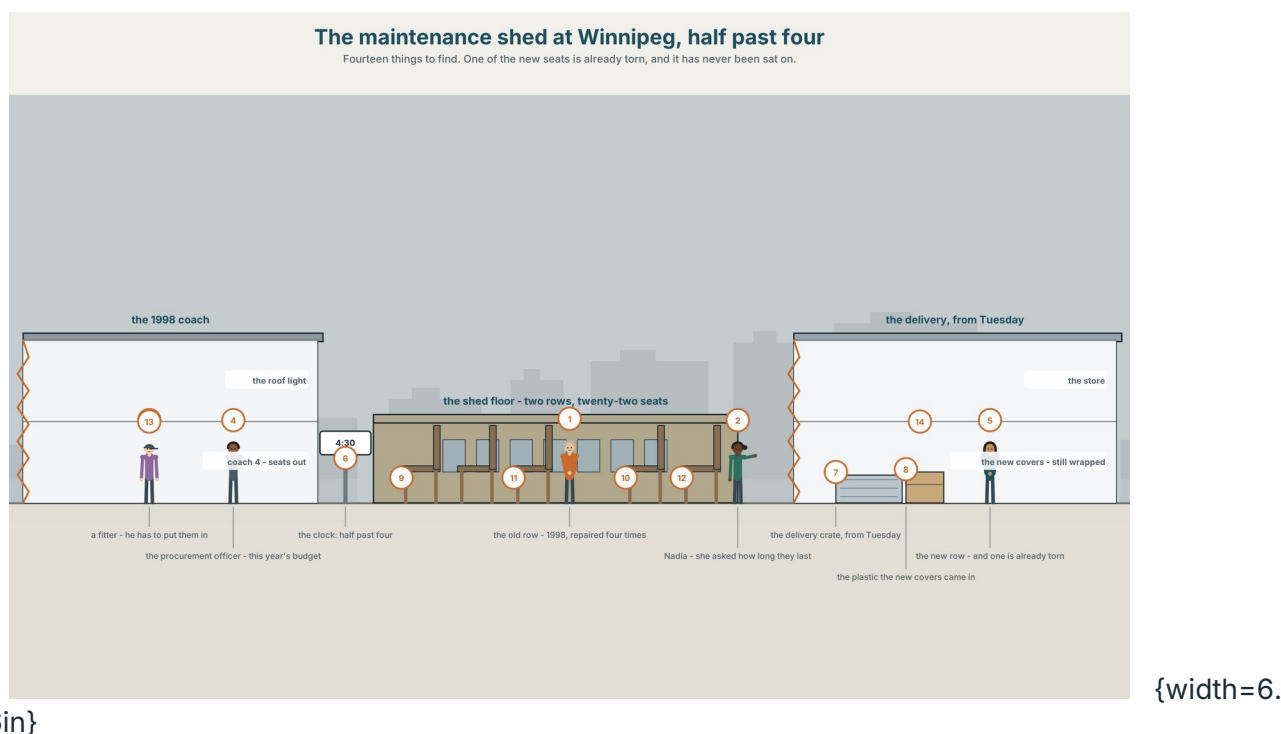


Table of Contents

A1.2 • Unit 3 • One Thousand Four Hundred Seats

English Animated • *Getting Around* • The Prairie Line, Toronto to Vancouver Student's Book
pages 50–71 • 22 pp • ~9 hours

Part 0 • The Big Picture ♦ A • THE WORLD



The maintenance shed at Winnipeg, half past four — Fourteen things to find. One of the new seats is already torn, and it has never been sat on.

Is cheaper always better?

By the end of this unit you can compare two things and say why you would choose one.

♦ A • THE WORLD

♦ B • THE SYSTEM

A shed with two rows of seats in it
and a decision worth half a million
dollars

comparative adjectives • 22 words
for price, quality and materials • *than*
and *as ... as* • the weak *than*, and the
sound that lives in half the words in
English

◆ A • THE WORLD

◆ C • THE PERFORMANCE

A shed with two rows of seats in it
and a decision worth half a million
dollars

You compare two things nobody can
tell apart and make the difference
matter

0A • Find it — fourteen things

Find these in the picture. Write the number.

☐ a seat ☐ cloth ☐ plastic ☐ metal ☐ wood ☐ a label ☐ a box ☐ a tear ☐ a repair ☐ a light ☐
a door ☐ a floor ☐ a bag ☐ a clock

Three of these words are not in the picture. Which three?

a price • the quality • a receipt

0B • Guess it

Look at the two rows. **Which row has been on a train?** Say one thing. You can use these words:

old • new • strong • same • different

0C • Say it

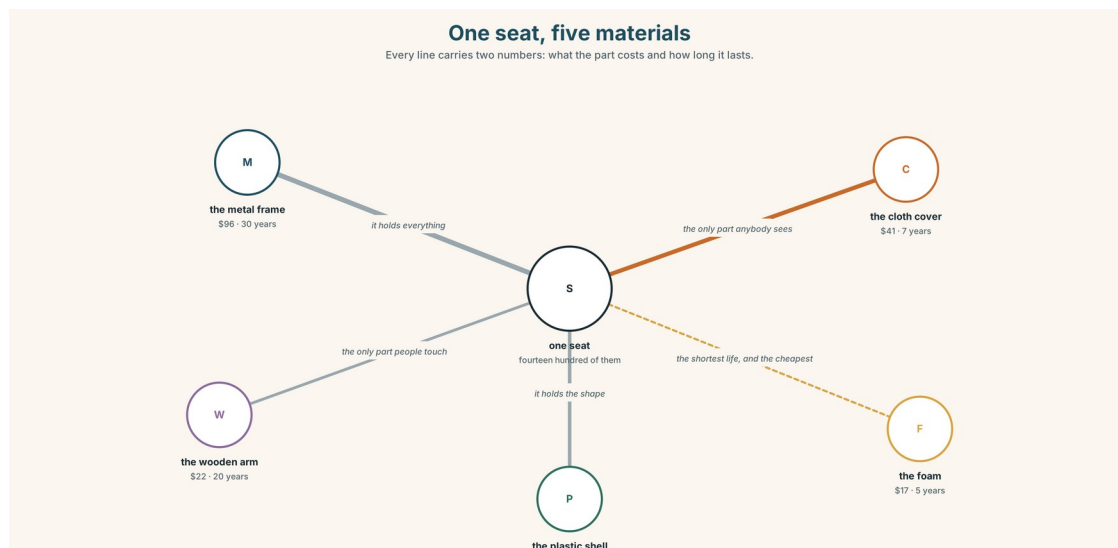
Record. Thirty seconds. Do not prepare.

Think of two things you own that do the same job. Which is better, and why?

You will listen to this again on the last page.

Part 1 • Vocabulary Lab 1 ◆ B • THE SYSTEM

1A • Meet — what a seat is made of



6in}

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One seat, five materials — Every line carries two numbers: what the part costs and how long it lasts.

price	What it says on the invoice.
cost	Price, plus everything that happens afterwards.
quality	The word people use when they cannot say which number they mean.
good value	Not cheap. Cheap for what you get.
break down	What a machine does. Also what an argument does.
throw away	The decision that is made at the moment of buying, not at the moment of throwing.

1B • Meet — the words

price • quality • cheap • expensive • better • worse • strong • weak • plastic • metal • wood • cloth • new • old • same • different

Write each word under the right picture.

the cover - \$41

cloth • the only part a passenger ever touches

the foam - \$17

five years • and nobody inspects it

the shell - \$34

plastic • it holds the shape and cracks in the cold

the frame and fixing - \$118

metal and wood • thirty years • nobody has ever replaced one

The cheapest visible part, and the whole argument

Five years, and it is replaced with the cover whether it needs it or not

Twelve years, and the cold is what kills it

More than half the money, and it will outlive the company

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6in}

One seat, in section — Eleven parts. Eleven words. The price of each part is beside it.

1C • Sort — the thing, or what you think of it?

Put each word in the right box. **Two of them can go in both. Which two, and why?**

metal • cheap • plastic • quality • wood • strong • cloth • price • new • weak

WHAT IT IS MADE OF	WHAT YOU THINK OF IT	BOTH
--------------------	----------------------	------

1D • Two words for the same money

cheap	a judgement, and usually not a kind one
good value	the same money, and a compliment
expensive	a judgement about the price
cost more	a fact about the price
last longer	the only one of these five that is a measurement
the same as	the comparison that says there is no comparison

Now say them. Three of these six are opinions and two are facts. **Which is the sixth, and why is it neither?**

1E • Stretch — the phrases you will need today

good value · last longer · cost more · break down · throw away

Match each phrase to the moment you need it.

1. You are explaining why you paid twice as much. → _____
2. The machine stops working in the middle of a shift. → _____
3. Somebody says the cheap one is the same. → _____
4. It cannot be repaired and it is three years old. → _____
5. You are comparing two invoices. → _____

1F • The hard one

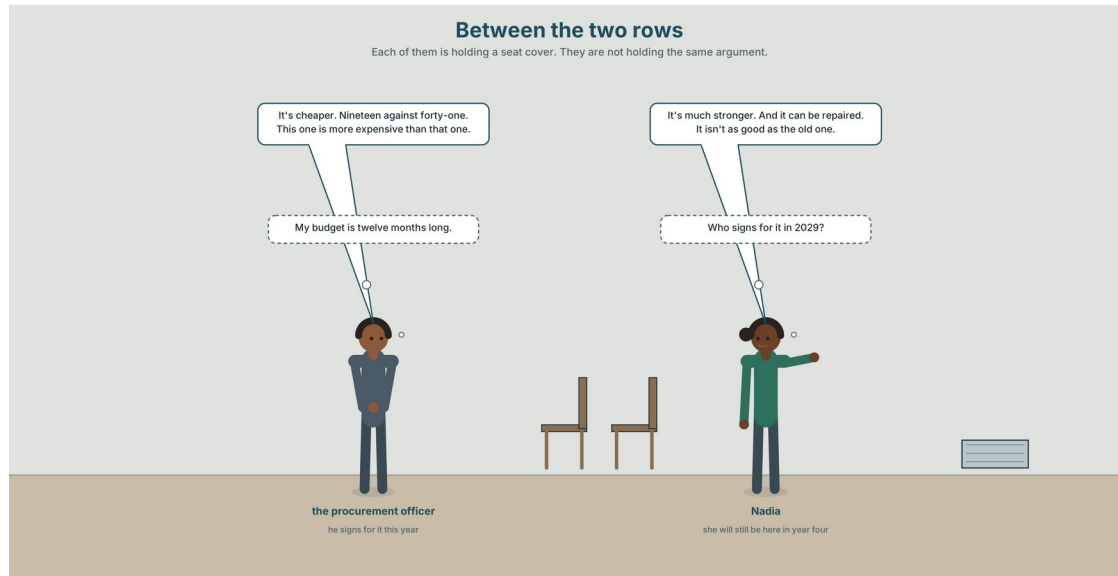
f It depends.

Practise it three times. **Two words that are the honest answer to almost every question in this unit, and the most annoying thing you can say to somebody who wants a number.**

1G • Own it

Write down two things you own that do the same job, and one sentence saying which is better. Do not write your name. The class guesses whose things they are.

Part 2 • Listening ♦ A • THE WORLD



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Between the two rows — Each of them is holding a seat cover. They are not holding the same argument.

2A • In the shed 🎧 Track 3.1

Before you listen. The company must replace one thousand four hundred seat covers. **Guess: which one will they choose?**

Listen once. One question. How much is the cheaper cover?

Listen again. Complete the table.

	Cloth	Synthetic
price each		
how long it lasts		
can it be repaired		

Listen again. True or false?

- The synthetic cover is cheaper. ☐ T ☐ F
- The cloth cover lasts longer. ☐ T ☐ F
- The synthetic one can be repaired. ☐ T ☐ F
- They cost the same over ten years. ☐ T ☐ F

Noticing. Four sentences from the recording.

- It's cheaper.*
- It's much stronger.*
- It isn't as good as the old one.*
- This one is more expensive than that one.*

Two of these add something to the end of the adjective and two put a word in front. What decides?

2B • Decoding clinic 🎧 Track 3.2

Twenty seconds of the procurement officer at speed. Three jobs.

- 1. Count the comparisons you hear.
- 2. *Than* is in four of them. Is it loud or quiet?
- 3. He says *more expensive than that* as three beats, not five words. Where did the other two go?

Transcripts, page 150.

Part 3 • Grammar Lab 1 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Putting two things next to each other

3A • Notice

Look at the four sentences in Part 2 again.

- 1. In sentences 1 and 2, what is on the end of the adjective?
- 2. In sentence 4, what word is in front of it instead?
- 3. Count the syllables in *cheap*, *strong* and *expensive*. What do you notice?
- 4. What word joins the two things being compared?

3B • See

How long is the adjective?

The length of the word decides the method. Nothing else does.

short	cheap → cheaper	1 syllable - add -er
	strong → stronger	1 syllable - add -er
	heavy → heavier	2 syllables ending in y - add -ier
	useful → more useful	2 syllables, no y - usually more
	expensive → more expensive	3 syllables - more
	good → better	no rule at all - learn it
long	bad → worse	no rule at all - learn it

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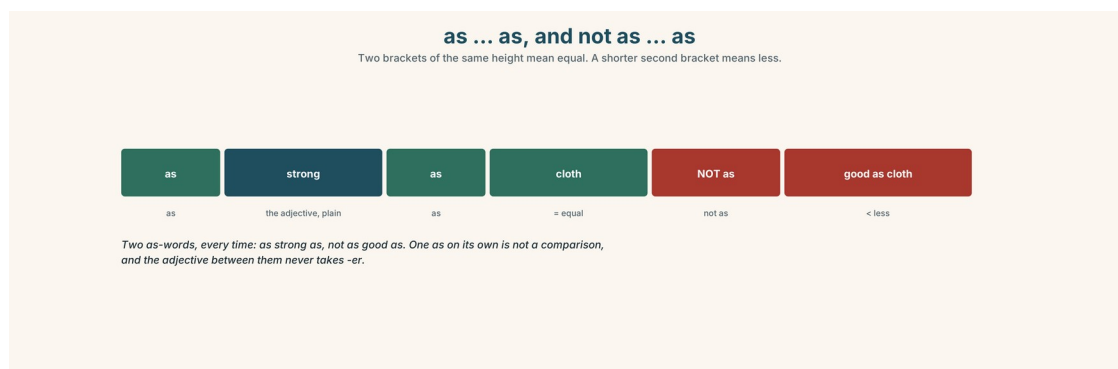
How long is the adjective? — The length of the word decides the method. Nothing else does.

3C • Know

one syllable	add -er	cheap → cheaper · strong → stronger · new → newer
two syllables	usually more, but -er	heavy → heavier ·

	after y	<i>useful → more useful</i>
three or more	more in front	<i>expensive → more expensive · difficult → more difficult</i>
the odd ones	no rule at all	<i>good → better · bad → worse · far → further</i>

Than joins the two things. *Cheaper than that one.* Without *than* the sentence is a comparison with something the listener has to guess, which is sometimes exactly what an advertisement wants.



6in}

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as ... as, and not as ... as — Two brackets of the same height mean equal. A shorter second bracket means less.

the same	<i>as strong as · as cheap as · the same as</i>
less	<i>not as good as · not as strong as</i>
by how much	<i>a bit cheaper · much better · far more expensive</i>
asking	<i>What's the difference? · It depends.</i>

Why it matters. Every decision anybody makes about money is a comparison, and the person who can say the comparison out loud is the person who wins the argument.

3D • Use — controlled

Complete with the comparative, **than**, **as** or **more**.

The synthetic cover is (1) _____ (cheap) than the cloth one. The cloth one is (2) _____ (strong). Synthetic is not (3) _____ good (4) _____ cloth, but it costs less. This one is (5) _____ expensive (6) _____ that one, and it lasts twice as long.

3E • Use — guided

Compare the two things in each pair, in one sentence.

1. cloth (19, 3 years)
2. metal (heavy, 30 years) / plastic (light, 8 years)
3. the old seat (repaired four times) / the new seat (torn already)

4. the train (four nights) / the plane (five hours)
5. a single ticket / a return ticket

3F • Use — open

In pairs. Choose two things in this room. **Compare them in five sentences without using the words *good* or *bad*.**

3G • Check — six items, mark your own

1. Synthetic is ____ (cheap) than cloth.
2. Cloth is ____ (strong).
3. It isn't ____ good ____ the old one. (*two words*)
4. This is ____ expensive than that.
5. × *It is more cheaper than cloth.* → correct it.
6. × *It is cheaper that cloth.* → correct it.

The comparison marked twice

✗ It is more cheaper than cloth.

more

Cheap is one syllable, so it takes -er, and once it has taken it the word is already a comparison. More in front says the same thing a second time. The sentence is not wrong because it is ungrammatical; it is wrong because it is paying twice for one idea.

✓ It is cheaper than cloth.

cheaper

One comparative marker, chosen by the length of the adjective: -er for short words, more for long ones. Never both. The only words that break this are good, bad and far, and they break it by changing shape entirely.

What the writer thought:
 More feels like an intensifier - like very - so it seems harmless to add. It is not an intensifier. It is the comparative itself, doing exactly the job that -er does, which is why the two cannot share a word.

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The comparison marked twice — The comparison marked twice

0–3 → Workbook pp. 12–15. **4–5** → Part 6. **6** → page 68.

Part 4 • Speaking ◆ C • THE PERFORMANCE

4A • Fluency starter — the comparison round

Everybody compares two things in the room, in one sentence. **No adjective may be used twice. Stop when somebody repeats one.**

4B • The functional core — comparing two things

The same numbers, two presentations
One compares on price. One compares on cost over ten years. They recommend opposite things.

on price

\$57,400 vs \$26,000 — buy synthetic



over ten years

\$86,100 vs \$88,700 — buy cloth



Find the six. Both are honest and both use the same figures. What has been changed is not a number - what is it?
6 differences — find them all

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The same numbers, two presentations — One compares on price. One compares on cost over ten years. They recommend opposite things.

Language Bank

more of something

cheaper than · stronger than · more expensive than

the same

as strong as · the same as

less

not as good as

by how much

a bit cheaper · much better · far more expensive

refusing to choose

It depends. · What's the difference?

Information gap. Learner A has the price list. Learner B has the repair records. **Work out which cover is cheaper over ten years.**

4C • The performance — the recommendation

Compare **two things that look the same to everybody else. Two minutes.** You must:

use three comparatives · use one *as ... as* · say by how much, with a number · end by recommending one, and say what would change your mind

Record it.

4D • Observer

One person listens for **one thing**: did anybody say *more* and *-er* on the same adjective?

4E • Two criteria

☐ Did I say *than* every time I compared two things? ☐ Did I give one number, and was it the right kind of number?

Part 5 • Reading ♦ A • THE WORLD

5A • Predict

The title is "**Nineteen dollars and forty-one dollars.**" Which one do you think the company bought?

5B • Read — sixty seconds

Nineteen dollars and forty-one dollars

A cloth seat cover costs forty-one dollars. It lasts about seven years and it can be repaired, usually three or four times. A synthetic cover costs nineteen dollars. It lasts about three years and it cannot be repaired at all.

Fourteen hundred seats. Cloth is fifty-seven thousand dollars and synthetic is twenty-seven.

Over ten years, cloth needs to be bought once and a half. Synthetic needs to be bought three and a third times. Cloth is eighty-six thousand over ten years and synthetic is eighty-nine.

The two numbers are almost the same. The difference is that the cloth money leaves in one year and the synthetic money leaves in four pieces, and the person who signs for it is not the same person each time.

That is not an argument about seats. It is an argument about who is still here in four years.

5C • Answer

1. How much is a cloth cover?
2. How long does a synthetic cover last?
3. How many seats are there?
4. What is the ten-year cost of each?
5. **Why does the writer say the two numbers are almost the same?**
6. **The last line says it is an argument about who is still here. What does that mean for the decision?**

5D • Vocabulary in context

Guess from the text. Then check.

it can be repaired • once and a half • leaves in one year • in four pieces • signs for it

5E • The counter-text

The supplier's comparison sheet

Eight rows. Six of them favour one column. Two of them are blank, and both blanks are in the same column.

NORTHFIELD TEXTILES - SEAT COVER COMPARISON

	CLOTH	SYNTHETIC
PRICE EACH	\$41.00	\$19.00
WEIGHT	940 g	610 g
CLEANING TIME	14 min	4 min
STAIN RESISTANCE	MEDIUM	HIGH
COLOURS AVAILABLE	4	11
DELIVERY	9 WEEKS	2 WEEKS
SERVICE LIFE	7 YEARS	(blank)
REPAIRABLE	YES, 3-4x	(blank)

AND AT THE BOTTOM

Recommended	SYNTHETIC
Saving on this order	\$30,800
Saving over ten years	(not shown)

The two blank rows are SERVICE LIFE and REPAIRABLE. The synthetic figures are three years and no. Both are known, both were asked for, and neither is on the sheet.

Less than half the price. This is the row the sheet is built on

Four minutes against fourteen - real, and worth money

Eleven colours. Nobody has ever chosen a seat cover for its colour

Two blanks, and they are the only two rows about time

The saving over ten years is three thousand, and it is the other way

{width=6.

The supplier's comparison sheet — Eight rows. Six of them favour one column. Two of them are blank, and both blanks are in the same column.

Read the sheet and answer.

1. What is the price of each cover?
2. **How many rows favour the synthetic cover, and which rows are they?**
3. Which two rows are blank?
4. **Both blanks are in one column. What are the two missing numbers, and why do you think they are missing?**

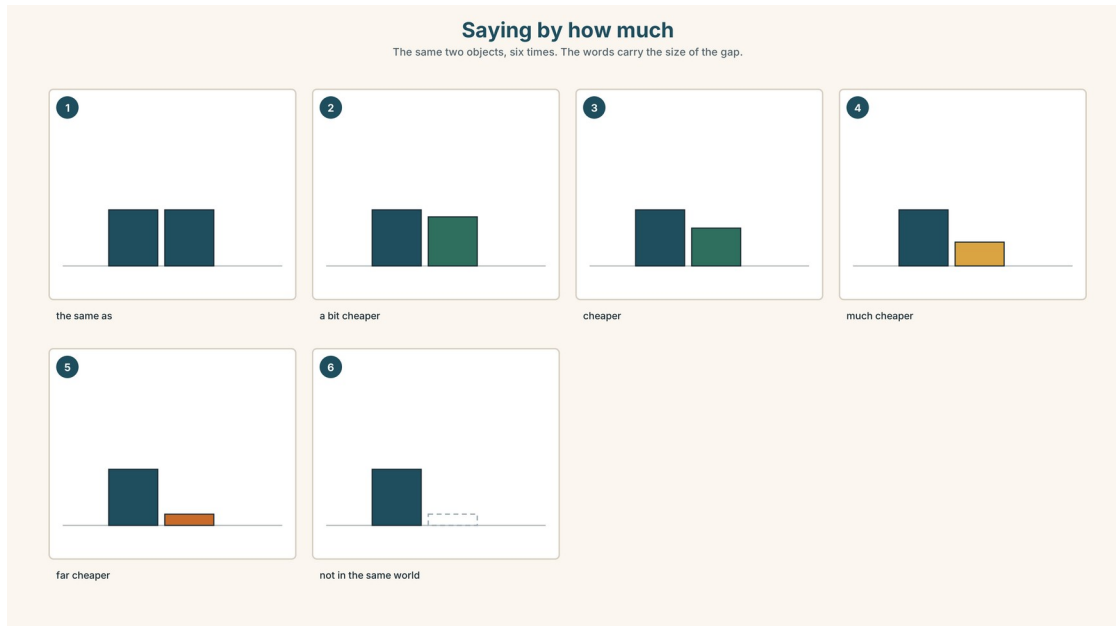
5F • Two texts

The reading says the ten-year costs are eighty-six and eighty-nine thousand. The comparison sheet says synthetic saves thirty thousand dollars.

Are both true? Say one sentence.

Part 6 • Vocabulary Lab 2 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Saying by how much



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6in}

Saying by how much — The same two objects, six times. The words carry the size of the gap.

6A • The ones that catch everybody

than	never <i>that</i> , and almost never stressed
a bit	small, and it sounds honest
much / far	big, and <i>far</i> is bigger than <i>much</i>
as ... as	two of them, every time. One <i>as</i> is not a comparison

6B • Say them

than • more • less • much • quite • really • a bit • as big as • not as good as

6C • Chunk

1. **a _____ cheaper** — a small difference
2. **_____ better** — a big difference
3. **as big _____** — the two things are equal
4. **not as good _____** — the second one is less
5. **more expensive _____** — the word that joins two things
6. **What's the _____ ?** — the question that asks for the comparison

6D • Contrast Clinic

Six items. **-er** or **more**?

1. cheap → _____

2. expensive → _____
3. strong → _____
4. difficult → _____
5. heavy → _____
6. useful → _____

Part 7 • Pronunciation & Fluency Lab ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

The sound in the middle of everything



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6in}

The small words stay small — Than, as, a and the are never the loud word. Six phrases, and the pattern never breaks.

7A • Hear

than → thun • **as** → uz • **a** → uh • **the** → thuh These four words are almost never said in full. The sound they all collapse to is the commonest sound in English and it does not have a letter of its own.

7B • Say

Say each one three times. Then say this:

It's cheaper than that one, and not as good as this one. — eleven words, five beats.

7C • Make it mean something

Say these two:

It's cheaper THAN that one. — you are correcting somebody
It's CHEAPER than that one. — you are telling them something new

Same words. The weak word becomes strong only when you are arguing. Which one sounds like a quarrel?

7D • Fluency 20

Twenty seconds: **six comparisons of things in this room, all with *than***. Three times, faster.

Part 8 • Writing C • THE PERFORMANCE

A recommendation • 50–70 words

8A • Read the model

There are two covers. One is forty-one dollars and one is nineteen. [the two numbers, with nothing else in the sentence]

The cheap one is not as strong, and it can't be repaired. [the difference that is not about price]

Over ten years they cost almost the same: eighty-six and eighty-nine thousand. [the number that changes the argument]

I would buy the cloth. If the budget were annual, I would buy the other one, and I would be wrong in year four. [the recommendation, and the condition]

Questions about the writer's choices:

1. The first sentence is two numbers and nothing else. **Why no adjective?**
2. *over ten years*. **Why is that phrase the whole argument?**
3. The last sentence admits the other choice. **Does that weaken the recommendation?**

8B • The anti-model

The cloth covers are better. They are stronger and they last longer. The synthetic ones are cheaper but they are not as good. I recommend the cloth ones.

Correct English, correct opinion, and no finance officer will read past line two. **Add three numbers and one condition under which you would choose the other one.**

8C • Plan

the two numbers → the difference that is not price → the number over time → the recommendation, and what would change it

8D • Write — 50 to 70 words

8E • Peer review — two things only

☐ Are there at least three numbers? ☐ Is there one sentence saying what would change the writer's mind?

8F • Publish

On the wall, with no names. **The class sorts them into *decided by price* and *decided by something else*.**

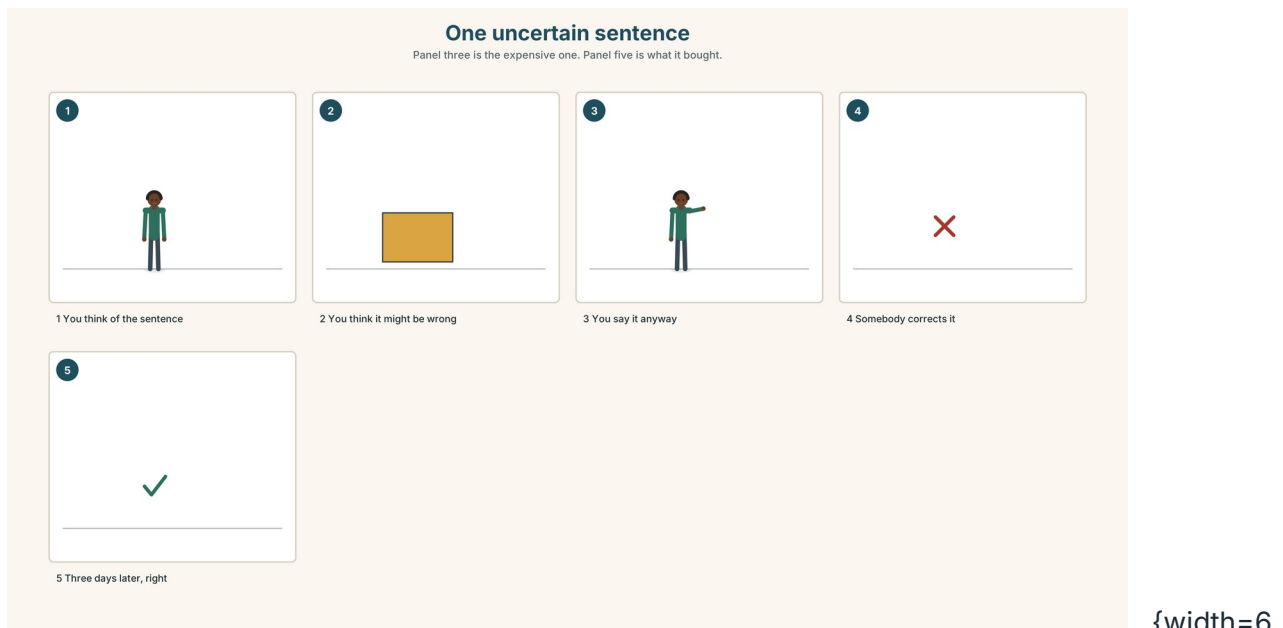
STUDY FILE • Cheap practice and expensive practice



6in}

Cheap practice and expensive practice — The time each one costs on the left, and what it produces on the right.

9A • The cost of being right



6in}

One uncertain sentence — Panel three is the expensive one. Panel five is what it bought.

Cheap

rereading, highlighting, watching.

Expensive

What cheap buys

What expensive buys

Comfortable, and almost free
producing something that might be
wrong, in front of somebody
the feeling of having studied
the thing itself

9B • Pay once

A mistake you make out loud costs you four seconds of embarrassment and buys you the correction. A mistake you avoid costs you nothing and buys you nothing. **Which did you do more of this week?**

9C • Role play — the cheapest possible lesson

In pairs. One of you has ten minutes and wants the most English for it. The other is the teacher and may only offer things that cost effort. **Negotiate. Nobody may say watch a video.**

9D • Your most expensive five minutes

Find the five minutes of your week in which you produce the most English with the least preparation. **That is the most valuable thing in your routine.** Name it.

9E • Transfer — before next week

Say one sentence a day that you are not sure about, out loud, to a person. Seven sentences. Write down what happened to each one.

Part 10 • Mediation & Interaction ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE



6in}

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Two covers, fifteen years — The totals are almost identical. The shape is completely different, and the shape is who signs.

10A • Relay

Half the class has the price list. Half has the repair records. **Work out the fifteen-year cost of each by speaking.** Ten minutes.

10B • Simplify — for one person

A colleague asks: *Why did we pay twice as much?* **Answer in four sentences.** Use one number and one comparison.

10C • Online

Write **one message** comparing two things a classmate is choosing between. **Three sentences.** Two comparatives and one *as ... as*.

10D • Your language

Does your language add something to the adjective, or put a word in front? **Say *cheaper* and *more expensive* in your language.** Is it the same method for both?

Part 11 • The Decision ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

One thousand four hundred seats

The company must replace fourteen hundred seat covers this year.

Cloth. Forty-one dollars each. Fifty-seven thousand now. Seven years, and repairable three or four times.

Synthetic. Nineteen dollars each. Twenty-seven thousand now. Three years, and when it tears it is finished.

Repair the old ones. Eleven dollars each and about nine months, and the people who can do the repair are four, and three of them retire within five years.

11A • The evidence

Two seats in year four

Both have been in service for four years. One of them is still in service.

cloth, year 4

2 repairs, both visible - in service · \$41 + \$22

synthetic, year 4

1 tear - withdrawn · \$19 + \$19 + \$19

Find the six. One of them is a small label under the seat, and it is the one the accountant will want.

6 differences — find them all

{width=6.

6in}

Two seats in year four — Both have been in service for four years. One of them is still in service.

 **Track 3.6.** Ruth, 20 seconds: "They asked me which seat is better. I've sat on both for nine hours. That's not the question. The question is which one is still here when I am."

11B • Talk about it

In threes. Use the frame. Everybody says one.

I think the company should buy _____, because _____.

Words you can use: price · quality · cheap · expensive · strong · weak · last longer

11C • Decide

Write **two sentences**. Choose, and say why.

I think the company should buy _____, because _____.

11D • Model decision

Cloth, and write down why. The ten-year numbers are three thousand dollars apart on a half million dollar decision, which means the money is not deciding this. Something else is, and if nobody writes down what, the same argument will be had again in three years by people who do not know it was already had.

11E • The Reveal

What happened. The company bought cloth and nobody wrote down why. Three years later a new officer opened the file, saw fifty-seven thousand against twenty-seven, and ordered synthetic for the next batch.

Then something nobody expected: the two kinds of cover are now mixed through the fleet, and the maintenance team can see both ageing side by side. In 2031 they will have the first real data anybody has ever had, by accident.

One question. You do not have to answer it out loud.

The company made the right decision and lost it. Which was the actual mistake?

Part 12 • Landing ♦ all three lines

12A • Recycle — twelve items

1. Synthetic is _____ (cheap) than cloth.
2. Cloth is _____ (strong).
3. It isn't as good _____ the old one.
4. This is _____ expensive than that.
5. a _____ cheaper — a small difference
6. _____ better — a big difference
7. It is the same _____ the other one.
8. These covers _____ than the old ones. (*two words — they stay usable for more years*)
9. The machine will _____ in year four. (*two words — stop working*)
10. What's the _____ ?
11. (*Unit 2*) _____ you buy it last summer?
12. (*Unit 1*) We _____ (go) to the shed at four.

12B • Consolidate — one task, everything in it

Compare two things somebody you know had to choose between, in six sentences. Three comparatives, one *as ... as*, two numbers, and one sentence saying what would have changed the decision.

12C • Can-do, with evidence

☐ I can compare two things. **Evidence:** 4C, 8D ☐ I can choose between *-er* and *more*.

Evidence: 3G, 6D ☐ I can say by how much. **Evidence:** 6C ☐ I can hear the weak words in a comparison. **Evidence:** 7C

12D • Replay 🟡

Record 0C again. **Listen to both.** What is different?

12E • Glossary — thirty-five words, as a map

THE MONEY • price • cheap • expensive • cost more • good value **THE JUDGEMENT** • quality • better • worse • strong • weak **THE MATERIAL** • plastic • metal • wood • cloth **THE STATE** • new • old • same • different • the same as **OVER TIME** • last longer • break down • throw away **COMPARING** • than • more • less • much • quite • really • a bit **COMPARING, IN WORDS** • as big as • not as good as • more expensive than • much better **ASKING** • What's the difference? • It depends.

12F • Next

Unit 4 • What makes a family?